

CHAPTER 3

Resistance and Resilience (1000–1700 CE)

NCERT Exercise Solutions

The Big Questions	4 Q
Let's Explore · Mewar's Resistance against Mughals	1 Q
Let's Recall · Marathas: The Quest for Swarājya	1 Q
Let's Explore · Bhakti Tradition	1 Q
Let's Map · Bhakti Saints	1 Q
Think About It · Vakh of Lāl Ded	1 Q
Think About It · Hunḍī	1 Q
Think About It · Indian Economy	1 Q
Questions and activities	10 Q

✨ Try each question yourself first, then check the answer. 💡 answers are samples: write your own.

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? The Big Questions

1 How did Indian rulers use resistance and alliances to safeguard their lands?

✔ ANSWER

- They fought invaders directly, e.g. Queen Nāikī Devī defeated Muhammad Ghūrī at Kasahrada (1178).
- Rajput kingdoms formed confederacies, e.g. Rāṇā Sāngā led a Rajput confederacy against Bābur at Khanua (1527).
- They used guerrilla warfare and local terrain (Mahārāṇā Pratāp in the Aravallis, Ahoms in Assam, Marathas in the Deccan hills).
- They built forts and made strategic alliances; the Marathas built a network of tributary relationships through alliances.

2 What factors contributed to the resilience of different kingdoms and communities during this period?

✔ ANSWER

- Knowledge of local terrain (forests, rivers, hills) and strong forts with water, food and armouries.
- Support of local people, e.g. the Bhil community helped Mewar.
- Strong organisation: the Ahom Paik system, the Sikh Khalsa and misals.

- Shared beliefs and traditions (Bhakti, temples) and a strong economy (agriculture, trade, hunḍī).

3 **How did the Bhakti tradition foster a sense of solidarity?**

✔ ANSWER

- It stressed equality and inclusion, so people of all backgrounds, including women, took part.
- Hymns were in local languages, which strengthened shared identities.
- Community singing (sankīrtan) and satsang drew large gatherings and built a shared sense of community.
- Devotion through nām kīrtan did not depend on buildings, so it was hard to suppress.

4 **How did the expansion of agriculture, trade, and commerce keep the economy sound?**

✔ ANSWER

- More land came under cultivation; irrigation (Persian wheel, rope pulleys, small-scale irrigation in Vijayanagara) raised output.
- Inland trade by caravans and banjārās linked villages with towns and Central Asia.
- Seaborne trade made India a major centre of the Indian Ocean network.

- Merchant groups and the hunḍī financed trade, giving people resources to resist and stay stable.

⭐ Let's Explore · Mewar's Resistance against Mughals

? **Dursā Arhā wrote of Mahārāṇā Pratāp: "...you kept your horses unbranded, your head unbowed... You never participated in the Nauroz festival, nor did you mount guard for the imperial presence during Jharokha Darshan."**

Identify any two specific actions mentioned in the text which show that Mahārāṇā Pratāp maintained his independence from the Mughal court.

✔ ANSWER

- He **never took part in the Nauroz festival** of the Mughal court.
- He **never mounted guard for the emperor during Jharokha Darshan**.

(Also: he kept his horses unbranded, i.e. without the Mughal mark, and his head unbowed.)

⭐ Let's Recall · Marathas: The Quest for Swarājya

? **What do you remember about the strategies and institutions that helped the Marathas**

establish their power?

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- A network of hill forts (e.g. Raigad, Sinhagad) used as bases, safe retreats and administrative centres.
- Guerrilla warfare using the hills and valleys of the Deccan: swift surprise attacks.
- Strategic alliances and tributary relationships that spread their influence.
- Good administration under Chhatrapati Śhivājī, with a council of ministers (Ashtapradhan) and the idea of swarājya (self-rule).

⭐ Let's Explore · Bhakti Tradition

? Explore the contributions of the Nayanar saints (devotees of Śhiva) like Karaikal Ammaiyar and the Alvar saints (devotees of Viṣhṇu) like Andal to the spread of the Bhakti tradition in peninsular India. Discuss their teachings and devotional practices and how they connected with people through their hymns.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- Nayanars (Śhiva devotees) and Alvars (Viṣhṇu devotees) composed hymns in Tamil, the language of ordinary people.

- Karaikal Ammaiyar, a woman Nayanar saint, gave up worldly life and sang of intense love for Śhiva.
- Andal, a woman Alvar saint, expressed her love for Viṣhṇu as a devotee longing for the Lord; her Tiruppāvai is still sung, especially in the month of Mārgaḻi.
- They taught that sincere love (bhakti) for God matters more than rituals or birth, and that anyone can reach God.
- They travelled from temple to temple singing hymns; people sang along, so devotion spread across peninsular India.

⭐ Let's Map · Bhakti Saints

? On a map of India, locate and label the present-day states associated with the saints in the infographic (Fig. 3.19). Also mark a saint from your own state who is not on the list. Are you familiar with any songs, poems or verses by these saints? Share and explain.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

State	Saints
Jammu and Kashmir	Lāl Ded
Punjab	Guru Nānak
Uttar Pradesh	Rāmānanda, Kabīr, Rāidāsa, Vallabhāchārya, Sūrdās, Tulsīdās
Rajasthan	Mīrābāī, Pīpājī

Odisha	Jayadeva
West Bengal	Chaitanya Mahāprabhu, Krittibāsa
Assam	Mādhava Kandalī, Sankardev
Karnataka	Basavannā, Mādhavāchārya
Andhra Pradesh	Annamāchārya
Telangana	Pothanā
Kerala	Poonthanam Namboothiri
Maharashtra	Ekanātha, Jñānadeva, Muktābāī, Nāmadeva, Janābāī, Chokhamelā, Tukārām
Gujarat	Narasimha Mehtā, Bhalana

Saint from your state: add one yourself (e.g. Delhi students may choose Amir Khusrau, Bihar students Dariya Sahib).

Example verse: Kabīr's dohā “Bura jo dekhan main chala, bura na milya koye...” means: when I looked for bad people I found none; when I looked into my own heart, I found none worse than me. It teaches us to correct ourselves before blaming others.

🤔 Think About It · Vakh of Lāl Ded

? **Lāl Ded says it is 'easy' to learn scriptures but 'hard' to live them. What is the difference between knowing a rule and actually following it? Can you give an example from your daily life?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- Knowing a rule means only remembering it; following it means acting on it every day, even when it is difficult or nobody is watching.
- Following needs self-control, effort and habit.
- Example: We all know we should not waste water or should stop at a red light, but some people still leave taps running or jump the signal. Living the rule means turning off the tap and waiting at the signal every time.

🤔 Think About It · Hunḍī

? **What do you think made hunḍī a safer and more convenient choice than physically transporting money across long distances?**

✔ ANSWER

- Traders did not have to carry large amounts of cash, so there was less risk of robbery or loss on the way.

- A hunḍī was a light piece of paper, easy to carry, like a cheque.
- It was trusted and paid through a network of sarrāfs and their agents (gumasthas) in other towns.
- It made big trade deals quick and easy without counting and moving heavy coins.

🤔 Think About It · Indian Economy

? Identify some cultural and economic pillars that exist in any community (places of faith, traditions, business and trade, etc.). How do you think these contribute to resilience within a society facing invasions/external pressures?

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- Pillars: temples and other places of faith, festivals and traditions, local languages and songs, farming, markets, crafts, merchant groups.
- Places of faith and traditions keep people united and give them a shared identity; even when temples were destroyed, Bhakti through songs kept faith alive.
- Farming, trade and crafts give food, money and resources to rebuild and to support resistance.

- Merchant networks and money (e.g. hunḍī) keep trade going and can fund rulers and allies.

So these pillars help a society survive, adapt and keep its way of life under pressure.

? Questions and activities

1 **Choose the most appropriate answer. Resistance and resilience are closely connected because:**

a. Resistance always involves warfare.

b. Resilience enables communities to endure difficulties and sustain resistance.

c. Resistance is possible only when a kingdom has a large army.

d. Resilient societies avoid all forms of conflict.

✔ ANSWER

b. Resilience enables communities to endure difficulties and sustain resistance.

Reason: the chapter says resilience is the backbone of resistance; the ability to endure comes from resilience.

2 **Why and how did groups such as the Sikhs, Marathas, and Rajputs assert their political power and identity during periods of changing political authority?**

✔ ANSWER

Why: to protect their lands, sovereignty, faith and culture from invasions, heavy taxes and religious persecution.

How:

- **Rajputs:** confederacies (Rāṇā Sāngā at Khanua, 1527); Mewar's long resistance — Mahārāṇā Pratāp's guerrilla warfare in the Aravallis, Battle of Dewair (1582); finally a treaty exempting Mewar's ruler from attending the Mughal court.
- **Marathas:** Chhatrapati Śhivājī's idea of swarājya; independent state in 1674; network of forts, guerrilla warfare and alliances; kept Aurangzeb busy in the Deccan for over two decades.
- **Sikhs:** after the martyrdom of Guru Arjan Dev and Guru Tegh Bahādur, Guru Hargobind set up the Akāl Takht (mīrī-pīrī); Guru Gobind Singh founded the Khalsa in 1699; later armed groups called misals.

3 **Why did some Rajput rulers decide to negotiate alliances with the Mughal power?**

✔ ANSWER

- The Mughal Empire was very powerful; cooperation helped them keep their kingdoms and positions safely.
- The Mughals needed Rajput military might, loyalty and administrative skill, so they offered mansabs (ranks) and other understandings.
- Such alliances gave rulers like the Kachhwāhas of Amber high rank, power and a share in the empire, instead of costly wars.

So relations were shaped by strategic considerations on both sides.

4 **Imagine a market in a port town such as Surat, Masulipatnam or Puducherry. You are a foreign trader from Italy or France wanting a deal of cotton textiles. How would you secure the product? Whose help would you seek, and what challenges would you face (language, quality, prices, etc.)?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

- I would first contact local Indian merchants and brokers who know the weavers and the market.
- I would hire a dubhaśhī (interpreter) to talk and bargain, since I don't know the local language.
- I would use sarrāfs (money-changers) to change my money and a hunḍī to pay safely.

- I would place an order in advance through merchants who give money to weavers, dyers and bleachers.

Challenges: language problems; checking that the cloth quality is the same as the sample; prices changing with demand and competition from Dutch, English and Portuguese traders; delays in delivery; customs duties at the port.

5 **Watch any video at https://www.indianculture.gov.in/forts-of-india/tales-of-forts and analyse the various functions of forts and fortresses. How did rulers perceive the importance of forts in terms of strategic concerns?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Functions of forts (from the chapter):

- Defence against invaders and safe retreats; bases for guerrilla attacks (Maratha forts like Raigad and Sinhagad).
- Advanced outposts and, on frontiers, fallback capitals to avoid total defeat.
- Centres of administration and justice.
- Strong walls, water sources, food stores and armouries let them withstand long sieges.

Rulers saw forts as key to survival and control: a network of forts on hills or difficult ground could guard territory and trade routes. E.g. Mahārāṇā Kumbhā built forts in Mewar; Gingee Fort's gateway could be held by a few soldiers against a large army.

(Add points from the video you watch.)

6 **What architectural changes occurred in temple construction during the period under study? How do these changes reflect upon the resilient nature of Indian civilisation?**

✔ ANSWER

Changes (from the 16th century onwards):

- Temples were built in less visible places, along narrow lanes, with entrances not opening onto main streets.
- Many looked like ordinary houses — 'havelī temples'.
- Detailed exteriors became less common; tall shikharas were often avoided.
- Examples: Delhi, Varanasi and Rajasthan, including the Jagat Shiromani Temple, Amer.

Resilience: communities adapted temple design to avoid destruction, so worship continued. Temples were also restored and rebuilt (e.g. Kashi Vishwanath by Toḍar Mal and Rājā Mān Singh). This shows the ability to adapt while keeping traditions alive.

7 **A kingdom has limited military resources but possesses fertile agricultural land, strong local support, and detailed knowledge of its terrain. Explain two ways in which these resources could contribute to the kingdom's resilience when faced with a threat.**

✔ ANSWER

1. **Terrain knowledge + local support:** the army can use guerrilla warfare — surprise attacks from forests, hills or rivers and safe retreats — like Mahārāṇā Pratāp in the Aravallis (helped by the Bhils) or the Ahoms in Assam. Local people act as guides and soldiers.

2. **Fertile land:** a steady supply of food and land revenue lets the kingdom store grain in forts, feed soldiers, survive long sieges and recover quickly after attacks.

8 **"A tradition becomes more resilient when people can carry it with them." Do you agree? Explain using examples from the Bhakti tradition.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Yes, I agree. A tradition that lives in people's minds and voices cannot be destroyed like a building.

- When temples were destroyed or restricted, devotees turned to nām kīrtan (reciting the divine Name), which needs no building.

- Bhakti spread through local songs and satsang, so it was hard to suppress.
- Hymns in local languages, e.g. Tulsidas's Rāmcharitmānas in Awadhi and Sankardev's Kīrtana Ghosha, reached every household.
- Sankīrtan (community singing) by Chaitanya Mahāprabhu and Guru Nānak united people; Chaitanya even used it to protest against a Qazi's restrictions.

9 **Voices from the Past: Choose any two (a Bhakti saint, a Rajput soldier, an Ahom commander, a Maratha administrator, a merchant, a Jat leader) and write a short first-person account explaining what resilience means from that person's perspective.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

A Bhakti saint: "They may break our temples, but they cannot break our devotion. I sing God's Name in my own language, in villages and streets, and people join me. Our faith lives in our songs and hearts. For me, resilience means keeping devotion alive in any situation."

An Ahom commander: "The Mughal army is large, but we know every river, forest and monsoon of Assam. With our light bāchārī boats and the Paik soldiers, we strike and retreat. Even when our capital fell, we rose again. For me, resilience means never giving up our freedom and using our land's strength."

10 **Design a Fort: As a military architect, draw a simple labelled plan of a fort with: residential complex, defensive walls, water source, food storage, escape route, watchtower, administrative area. Then explain how your design would help the kingdom withstand a long siege.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Plan (draw in your notebook): a fort on a hilltop with **thick double defensive walls** and one strong main gate; **watchtowers** at the corners; in the centre the **administrative area** (court, treasury, armoury); next to it the **residential complex**; a **water tank/well** on the high side; **granaries (food storage)** near the residences; a hidden **escape route** (secret tunnel or small gate) leading down to the forest.

How it helps in a long siege:

- Thick walls and watchtowers stop and spot the enemy early.
- Its own water source and food stores keep people alive for months.

- The administrative area keeps government and justice working.
- The escape route allows safe retreat, sending messages or bringing supplies — like Maratha forts that were self-sufficient fallback bases.

🎉 **Chapter 3 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.**